



City of Somerville, Massachusetts

City Council

Regular Meeting Agenda

Thursday, September 10, 2026

7:00 PM

**City Council Chamber and Remote
Participation**

Published September 8, 2026, 1:30 P.M.

NOTICE: Pursuant to Chapter 2 of the Acts of 2025, this meeting of the City Council may be conducted via remote participation. We will post an audio recording, audiovideo recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of these proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting on the City of Somerville website and local cable access government channels.

Register at the following website to listen to this meeting live or to testify at any public hearing:
https://us02web.zoom.us/webinar/register/WN_Eb_ilip3TyKo2dUgQ7pYPg

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1. OPENING CEREMONIES

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| 1.1. | Roll Call
(ID # 26-1370) | Call of the Roll. |
| 1.2. | Remembrances
(ID # 26-1371) | Remembrances. |
| 1.3. | Minutes
(ID # 26-1372) | Approval of the Minutes of the Regular City Council Meeting of July 9, 2026. |

2. CITATIONS

3. PUBLIC HEARINGS

4. ORDERS, ORDINANCES, RESOLUTIONS AND MOTIONS OF MEMBERS

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| 4.1. | Resolution
(ID # 26-1217) | By Councilor McLaughlin
Recognizing the seriousness of myotonic dystrophy and expressing support for the designation of September 15, as “International Myotonic Dystrophy Awareness Day”. |
| 4.2. | Resolution
(ID # 26-1359) | By Councilor Clingan
In support of striking Encore Boston Harbor workers. |

- 4.3. Resolution (ID # [26-1360](#)) By Councilor Clingan
That the Director of Engineering and the Commissioner of Public Works discuss with the Committee on Public Utilities and Public Works the City's current requirements for restoration of streets following utility and other permitted excavations, including whether the City has the authority and ability to require full-lane, expanded, or curb-to-curb restoration on streets that have passed the five-year street opening moratorium but remain in good condition.
- 4.4. Resolution (ID # [26-1361](#)) By Councilor Clingan
That the Director of Engineering and Commissioner of Public Works discuss with the Committee on Public Utilities and Public Works the feasibility of establishing a Street Preservation Offset Fee or similar pavement-degradation fee, modeled on programs such as Cambridge's, to help offset the City's costs associated with utility and other excavations in public streets.
- 4.5. Resolution (ID # [26-1362](#)) By Councilor Clingan
That the Director of Engineering, the Commissioner of Public Works, and the Chief Procurement Officer discuss with the Committee on Public Utilities and Public Works the City's current practices for establishing, monitoring, and enforcing construction timelines for municipal projects, including the use of project milestones, completion deadlines, contractor staffing levels, liquidated damages, and other tools to ensure that projects are completed in a timely manner.
- 4.6. Resolution (ID # [26-1363](#)) By Councilor Clingan
That the Director of Engineering, the Commissioner of Public Works, and the Chief Procurement Officer explore best practices used by other municipalities and public agencies to encourage timely completion of public construction projects, including performance incentives, liquidated damages, milestone requirements, recovery schedules, and cost-plus-time or "A+B" bidding, and discuss which approaches could be appropriate for Somerville.

5. UNFINISHED BUSINESS

6. REPORTS OF COMMITTEES

7. COMMUNICATIONS OF THE MAYOR

- 7.1. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1364](#)) Requesting that this Council convene in Executive Session to receive an update on collective bargaining negotiations.
- 7.2. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1258](#)) Requesting ordainment of an amendment to Sections 3.2.17, 4.1.15, 4.2.15, 4.3.15, 4.4.15, 5.1.16, 6.1.13, 6.2.14, 6.3.13, 6.4.16, 6.5.13 of the Somerville Zoning Ordinance to correct parking maximums.
- 7.3. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1259](#)) Requesting ordainment of an amendment to Sections 2.4.4, 3.1.7, 3.1.8, 3.1.9, 3.1.10, 3.1.11, 3.2.7, 3.2.8, 3.2.9, 3.2.10, 3.2.11, 4.1.7, 4.2.7, 4.3.7, 4.4.7 of the Somerville Zoning Ordinances to remove ground story elevation requirements.
- 7.4. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1261](#)) Requesting ordainment of an amendment to Sections 3.1.5, 3.2.5, 6.3.5, 6.4.6, 7.3.5, 8.3.6, 10.10.3, 15.2.1, 15.3.2, 15.7.2 of the Somerville Zoning Ordinance to streamline the jurisdiction of review boards.
- 7.5. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1336](#)) Requesting ordainment of an amendment to Sections 3.1.3, 3.1.6, 3.1.8, 3.1.9, 3.1.11, 3.1.12, 3.1.13, 3.1.16, 3.2.6 of the Somerville Zoning Ordinance to align with State Law regarding protected accessory dwelling units.
- 7.6. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1337](#)) Requesting ordainment of an amendment to Sections 2.4.5, 3.1.17, 3.2.16, 4.1.8, 4.1.9, 4.1.14, 4.2.8, 4.2.9, 4.2.14, 4.3.8, 4.3.9, 4.3.14, 4.4.8, 4.4.9, 4.4.15, 5.1.7, 5.1.8, 5.1.9, 5.1.16, 6.1.12, 6.2.7, 6.2.8, 6.2.14, 6.3.12, 6.4.9, 6.4.15, 6.5.7, 7.2.8 of the Somerville Zoning Ordinance to clarify requirements for principal entrances.
- 7.7. Mayor's Request (ID # [26-1338](#)) Requesting ordainment of an amendment to Sections 2.1.1, 2.4.5, 3.1.16, 3.2.8, 3.2.9, 3.2.10, 3.2.11, 3.2.15, 4.1.3, 4.1.7, 4.1.8, 4.1.9, 4.1.10, 4.1.13, 4.2.3, 4.2.7, 4.2.8, 4.2.9, 4.2.10, 4.2.13, 4.3.3, 4.3.7, 4.3.8, 4.3.9, 4.3.10, 4.3.13, 4.4.3, 4.4.7, 4.4.8, 4.4.9, 4.4.13, 5.1.3, 5.1.7, 5.1.8, 5.1.9, 5.1.10, 5.1.11, 5.1.14, 6.1.3, 6.1.7, 6.1.8, 6.1.11, 6.2.3, 6.2.7, 6.2.8, 6.2.9, 6.2.12, 6.3.3, 6.3.8, 6.4.3, 6.4.9, 6.4.11, 6.5.3, 6.5.7, 6.5.8, 6.5.11, 7.2.7, 7.2.10, 7.4.3, 7.4.6, 7.4.7, 7.4.8, 7.4.11, 8.1.1, 8.1.2, 8.1.4, 8.1.5, 8.1.6, 8.2.2, 8.2.4, 8.2.5, 8.4.16, 8.4.17, 8.4.19, 9.1.7, 12.1.1, 12.1.2, 12.1.4, 12.1.5, 12.1.6, 12.1.7, 12.3.5, 12.3.6, 12.3.7 of the Somerville Zoning Ordinance to update terminology for affordable dwelling units and commercial spaces.

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| 7.8. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1334) | Requesting approval to appropriate \$350,000 from the Immigrant Legal Services Stabilization Fund for legal services for immigrants and asylum seekers seeking permanent residency. |
| 7.9. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1240) | Requesting approval to appropriate \$255,045 from the Transportation Network Receipts Reserved Account to the Transportation Network Revolving Account for Fiscal Year 2027 Vision Zero efforts. |
| 7.10. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1322) | Requesting approval to accept and expend a \$295,463 grant with no new match required, from the State 911 Department to the Police Department for E911 dispatcher personnel costs. |
| 7.11. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1254) | Requesting approval to accept and expend a \$215,919.15 grant with no new match required, from the Metropolitan Area Planning Council to the Health and Human Services Department for a Shared Services Coordinator and a Clinical Community Health Worker. |
| 7.12. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1323) | Requesting approval to accept and expend a \$159,754.04 grant with no new match required, from the State 911 Department to the Police Department for training costs for E911 dispatcher certification and recertification. |
| 7.13. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1320) | Requesting approval to accept and expend a \$24,500 grant with no new match required, from the State 911 Department to the Police Department for emergency medical dispatch. |
| 7.14. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1221) | Requesting approval to accept and expend a \$9,809.81 grant that requires a match, from the United States Bureau of Justice Assistance to the Somerville Police Department for body armor vests. |
| 7.15. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1341) | Requesting approval to pay prior year invoices totaling \$80,852.95 using available funds in various Department of Public Works accounts for various services. |
| 7.16. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1271) | Requesting approval to pay prior year invoices totaling \$1,687.50 using available funds in the Fire Department Professional and Technical Services Account for medical screening services. |
| 7.17. | Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1328) | Requesting approval to pay prior year invoice totaling \$19.76 using available funds in the Immigrant Advancement Professional and Technical Services Account for on demand phone interpretation services. |
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| 7.18. Mayor's Request
(ID # 26-1335) | Requesting approval of a revised fee schedule for permit applications submitted to the Planning Board, Historic Preservation Commission, and Zoning Board of Appeals. |
| 7.19. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1365) | Proclaiming that the week of September 10 through September 19, 2026 is Welcoming Week. |
| 7.20. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1366) | Proclaiming that September 15, 2026 is International Myotonic Dystrophy Awareness Day. |
| 7.21. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1353) | Conveying an update on Civilian Oversight. |
| 7.22. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1330) | Conveying the appointment of Lena Warnke to the Somerville Arts Council Board. |
| 7.23. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1331) | Conveying the appointment of Josh Breeden to the Somerville Arts Council Board. |
| 7.24. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1332) | Conveying the appointment of Sharon Lacey to the Somerville Arts Council Board. |
| 7.25. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1333) | Conveying the appointment of Bess Paupeck to the Somerville Arts Council Board. |
| 7.26. Mayor's Communication
(ID # 26-1367) | Conveying the appointment of Christopher Oates to the Ranked Choice Voting Committee. |

8. COMMUNICATIONS OF CITY OFFICERS

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| 8.1. Officer's Communication
(ID # 26-1339) | Director of Emergency Management conveying the 2025-2026 Cummings School Winter Warming Center After Action Report and Improvement Plan. |
| 8.2. Officer's Communication
(ID # 26-1352) | City Clerk conveying Block Party Licenses issued. |

9. NEW BUSINESS

- 9.1. Public Event (ID # [26-1349](#)) Theatre@First applying for a Public Event License for Iphigenia by Euripides on various dates between September 26 and October 11 from 3pm to 7:30pm.
- 9.2. Public Event (ID # [26-1351](#)) Saint Benedict Parish applying for a Public Event License for Journey to World Youth Day 2027 Fundraiser on September 12 from 11:30am to 2pm (raindate September 19).
- 9.3. Public Event (ID # [26-1348](#)) Matthew Taylor applying for a Public Event License for 21st Honk! Festival on October 9, 10 & 11 for various times.
- 9.4. Public Event (ID # [26-1346](#)) Bow Market applying for a Public Event License for Bow Market Renaissance Faire on November 7 from 8am to 8:30pm (raindate November 14).
- 9.5. Public Event (ID # [26-1347](#)) Somerville Road Runners applying for a Public Event License for 30th Annual Gobble Gobble Gobble Road Race on November 26 from 6am to 1pm.
- 9.6. Public Event (ID # [26-1350](#)) Mayor's Office applying for a Public Event License for City Hall Truck O' Treat 2026 Spectacular! on October 29 from 4pm to 8pm (raindate November 5).
- 9.7. License (ID # [26-1342](#)) New Drainlayer's License, Valor Excavation, LLC.
- 9.8. License (ID # [26-1343](#)) New Livery License, Lubana Coach, 2 Snow Terrace, operating 1 vehicle.
- 9.9. License (ID # [26-1344](#)) New Second Hander Dealer License, Somerville Communications, 52 Broadway.
- 9.10. License (ID # [26-1345](#)) Renewing Taxi Medallion License, Country Club Transportation Inc, Med. #3,4,5,7,8,9,10,11,12,13,46.
- 9.11. Public Communication (ID # [26-1368](#)) Bruce Schulman submitting comments re: snow emergencies.
- 9.12. Public Communication (ID # [26-1369](#)) Marianne Walles submitting comments re: item #26-1268, comments related to Zoning Ordinance Sections 3.1.7c, 3.1.8c, 3.1.9c, 3.1.10c, 3.1.11c, 3.1.15a.i, 3.2.7c, 3.2.8c, 3.2.9c, 3.2.10c, 3.2.11c, 4.1.7c, 4.2.7c, 4.3.7c, 4.4.7c.

10. SUPPLEMENTAL ITEMS

11. ADJOURNMENT